



MARKETING LABS · IMPACT & RESEARCH

Impact Pathway Canvas

Make the route from research to real-world change visible.

Impact Pathway Canvas: map research findings to stakeholders, engagement, outcomes and evidence.

Includes: framework reference · guidance by Pathway stage · printable worksheet

Impact Pathway Canvas: reference

INTERACTIVE IMPACT-PLANNING PROTOTYPE

Build an impact pathway by linking a research finding to the people who matter, the engagement activity that could enable use, the change you intend to contribute to, and the evidence needed to make a responsible claim later.

A pathway is a hypothesis, not proof of impact. It helps a team test whether the finding is relevant, whether people can use it, what engagement is appropriate, and what evidence should be captured as activity unfolds.

Impact pathway

Drag cards to organise the map. Click a card to inspect its contribution, owner and evidence or assumption.

Finding

Stakeholder

Activity

Outcome

Evidence

Contribution pathway

Assumption view

PATHWAY COVERAGE

All five stages are represented. Check whether the links explain a credible route rather than a linear promise.

EVIDENCE READINESS

1 evidence card added. Ensure each records a specific source, timing and what it can—and cannot—support.

ENGAGEMENT PROMPT

2 stakeholder cards and 2 activity cards added. Clarify which activities are genuinely two-way and how participants can influence the work.

Impact-plan review prompts

- ? Which specific research finding underpins this pathway, and what are its limits or uncertainties?
- ? Who benefits, who decides, who may be affected, and how are those groups able to shape interpretation or action?
- ? Does the engagement activity involve listening, exchange, co-design or accountability—not only one-way dissemination?
- ? What needs to happen between the activity and the intended outcome, and what external conditions could disrupt that route?
- ? What evidence will show use, change, reach and significance rather than merely outputs, attendance or media coverage?
- ? Which claims are planned, which are documented, and which have independent external corroboration?

Guidance by Pathway stage

Research finding

Stakeholder / beneficiary

Engagement activity

Outcome or intended change

Evidence of impact

Impact Pathway Canvas: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Research project or programme

For example: Satellite evidence for healthier local places

Pathway stage

- ☐ Research finding ☐ Stakeholder / beneficiary ☐ Engagement activity ☐ Outcome or intended change
- ☐ Evidence of impact

Status

- ☐ Planned ☐ Active ☐ Documented ☐ Externally validated

Card title

For example: Local authority planning teams

What does this contribute?

Describe the research, user, activity, outcome or evidence source in specific terms.

Owner or partner

For example: Principal investigator and local authority climate team

Assumption, risk or dependency

What has to be true for this part of the pathway to work?

Connect from

Connections describe a plausible contribution pathway. They do not establish causation or prove later impact.

- ☐ Start a new pathway ☐ Research finding: Urban heat pattern
- ☐ Stakeholder / beneficiary: Neighbourhood organisations ☐ Engagement activity: Evidence workshops
- ☐ Stakeholder / beneficiary: Local authority planning teams ☐ Engagement activity: Decision-ready map and briefing
- ☐ Outcome / intended change: Better local prioritisation ☐ Evidence of impact: Traceable evidence of use and change

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.